

How We Work From Here

A step-by-step working plan, written so that everyone on the project — technical or not — can follow what happens, in what order, and why.

Field	Detail
Document	Website Rebuild — Phased Working Plan, version 1
Prepared	24 August 2026
Project folder	C:\xampp\htdocs\sherubtse-college
Git branch	feature/faculty-profile-system
Audience	IT Section, project owner, developers, content contributors
Related	docs/DECISIONS.md · Website Build Brief · Visual Style Guide v1.4

Contents

1. **How to read this document** — Why the order matters, and the words used here
2. **Where things stand today** — What is built, what is empty, and what is broken
3. **The seven phases at a glance** — Effort and people needed for each
 - Phase 0 — Restore the working files** — Blocking. Half a day.
 - Phase 1 — Lock the colour system** — The approved palette and the rules around it
 - Phase 2 — Freeze the site structure** — Decisions that must be closed first
 - Phase 3 — Rebuild the navigation bar** — The five pieces of the bar, and what is wrong with each
 - Phase 4 — Finish the page templates** — Making them work with real content
 - Phase 5 — Load the real content** — The longest part of the project
 - Phase 6 — Infrastructure and launch** — Including two items already overdue
4. **How each working session runs** — The standing rules
5. **Decisions needed from IT Section** — Five yes-or-no questions
6. **What is not part of this project** — The network RFP and the Moodle update
7. **Where to start, today** — One command

1. How to read this document

The website rebuild is one long job made of many small ones. This document breaks it into seven phases. Each phase has a short explanation of why it exists, a numbered list of steps, and a "Done when" line — a plain, checkable condition that must be true before the next phase starts.

You do not need to read the whole document to be useful to the project. Read section 2 to understand where things stand, then read the phase you are involved in.

The order is not a preference

Colour is settled before structure, because the colours are stored in one file that every page reads from. Structure is settled before the navigation bar, because a navigation bar is simply a picture of the site structure — you cannot design a menu for pages whose shape has not been agreed. Working out of order means doing the same work twice.

Words used in this document

Term	What it means, plainly
Strapi	The admin system where College staff type in content — notices, staff profiles, programmes. It runs privately on a College server and is never open to the public internet.
Astro	The tool that takes the content out of Strapi and turns it into ordinary web pages. It does this once, in advance, so the public website is just plain files — fast and hard to attack.
The old PHP site	The current website in this folder. It is being replaced, not repaired. Nothing in this plan changes it.
Design tokens	One file listing every approved colour, text size and spacing value. Pages never contain colour codes of their own; they read them from this file. Change the file, the whole site changes.
Template	The reusable design of a type of page — one Department template serves all departments, one Profile template serves all staff.
Git	The system that keeps every version of the project files. Work that is not committed and pushed to Git exists on one laptop only.
Build	The step that turns content plus templates into the finished website. If the build fails, there is no website to look at.

2. Where things stand today

READ THIS BEFORE STARTING ANYTHING

One thing is broken, and it blocks everything else

The project record says the new website was built and checked: ten page templates, twenty-six pages, a clean build. Git agrees — it is holding 57 files for the new site.

Only 15 of those 57 files are actually on the computer. Every file in the content folder is gone, all four page templates are gone, and 24 of the 26 page addresses are gone. The header file still asks for a navigation file that is no longer there, so the website cannot currently be built at all.

The good news: nothing is lost. The files are safely stored in Git and one command brings them back. But until that is done, there is no website to redesign, and no way to check whether anything else in this plan works.

Summary of every part of the project

Part	Status	What is actually there
New website files	BROKEN	15 of 57 files present. Only the homepage and search page survive. Will not build.
Content system (Strapi)	BUILT	14 content types plus 3 settings types are in place. The menu and site-settings records are still empty.
Actual content	EMPTY	8 programmes and 3 departments entered. Notices, events, staff profiles, news and documents: none.
Current live PHP site	UNTOUCHED	Still maroon and gold. Frozen on purpose — it is being replaced, not restyled.
Colour system	NEEDS A LOCK	Two different palettes exist in one project: maroon for the old site, navy for the new one.
Content model sign-off	PROVISIONAL	Two decisions were made by default and are still reversible until IT Section confirms them.
Live production site	COMPROMISED	Gambling spam is embedded in the live homepage and a 2,000-address spam sitemap exists. Separate from this project, and urgent.

3. The seven phases at a glance

Phase	What happens	Rough effort	Who is needed
0	Restore the missing files	Half a day	Developer
1	Lock the colour system	1–2 days	Developer + whoever approves branding
2	Freeze the site structure	2–3 days	IT Section decisions + developer
3	Rebuild the navigation bar	3–4 days	Developer
4	Finish the page templates	1–2 weeks	Developer
5	Load the real content	Several weeks	Departments, HR/Admin, photographer
6	Infrastructure and launch	Ongoing	IT Section / hosting owner

Phases 0 to 4 are mostly one person working steadily. Phase 5 depends on many people across the College and is the longest part of the whole project. Phase 6 contains two items that should not wait for the rest — see section 10.

Phase 0 — Restore the working files

BLOCKING • ABOUT HALF A DAY

Nothing else in this plan can be tested until the website can be built again. This is the first thing anyone does.

0.1 Find out exactly what is missing

Open a command window in the project folder and run `git status`. Read the list of deleted files. Confirm that the 42 missing files appear as deletions, and that this is not a folder that was simply moved or renamed.

0.2 Bring the files back

Run `git restore web/`. This restores the last saved version of every missing file.

If anything currently on the computer is newer and worth keeping, save it aside first with `git stash`. Never force files over unsaved work.

0.3 Check that the website builds

Start the content system: `cd cms && npm run develop`. Then build the site: `cd web && npm install && npm run build`. A correct result produces 26 pages and a search index.

If the build fails because a font package is missing or the access token is empty, fix those first — those are ordinary setup problems and do not mean anything else is wrong.

0.4 Work out why the files disappeared

Write the cause into `docs/DECISIONS.md`. If something deleted them once — a tool, a script, an antivirus, a bad checkout — it will do it again in the middle of the redesign. This step is not optional.

0.5 Push the work to the server

Run `git push`. At the moment, a month of work exists on one laptop and nowhere else. That is the single largest risk in the whole project and it takes one command to remove.

Done when: the build command finishes without errors and produces 26 pages, and the branch has been pushed.

Phase 1 — Lock the colour system

1 TO 2 DAYS

The aim of this phase is a single approved list of colours, each with one job, written into one file. Everything built afterwards reads from that file. Skipping this means colour decisions get made again on every page, and the site slowly drifts.

The approved palette

Name	Code	What it is for
Navy	#0D1B4B	The top bar, the footer, main buttons. This is the structure colour. It is not used as an accent and it is not used for body text.
Gold	#F0B429	The quick-links strip, the gold line under the top bar, focus outlines. A surface and a marking colour — never text.
Gold ink	#8A6410	The only gold dark enough to be readable as text. Used for small labels and link hover, nothing else.
Ink	#14161B	All body text and all headings.
Red	#B3261E	Reserved meaning only: deadlines within seven days, closures, corrections.
Green	#1E6B4F	Reserved meaning only: applications open, registration live, results published.

1.1 Settle the navy

The Style Guide specifies #0D1B4B. Measuring the actual College crest gives #1D204D. They look like the same colour but they are not the same value, and having both in the project guarantees a mismatch later.

Recommendation: keep #0D1B4B. It is the darker of the two, its readability against white is already measured and approved, and every existing file already uses it. Write the other value out of the project entirely.

1.2 Confirm the gold against the crest

The gold keyline in the crest measures #D1AC06 — it sits between the two golds already in the palette, so the palette gold is legitimate and no change is needed.

The bright yellow inside the crest shield is #FCEA00. It is far brighter and greener than any palette colour. It must not be added to the palette, and the crest must never be placed on a gold background — the two yellows clash badly.

1.3 Make the gold-as-text rule enforceable

Gold #F0B429 is not readable as text. Only #8A6410 may be set as type. Put this on the review checklist, not only in a document — a rule that lives only in a document is a rule that gets broken.

1.4 Declare the maroon closed for the new build

The old site's maroon and gold stay exactly as they are until the new site replaces the old one. No new work touches that file, and no navy leaks into it. The two colour systems live side by side until switch-over day, and then one of them is deleted.

1.5 Put the two reserved colours on the checklist

Red and green in this palette carry meaning, not decoration. If a page uses red because it looked good, that is a defect, not a style choice.

1.6 Get the real crest file

The project currently carries a 1.6 MB photograph of the crest. The top bar needs a proper vector version: SVG format, square, transparent background. This is needed **before** the navigation work in Phase 3, not after it.

Done when: one colour code per job in the tokens file, no near-duplicates anywhere in the project, and the crest supplied as an SVG.

Phase 2 — Freeze the site structure

2 TO 3 DAYS, MOST OF IT WAITING ON DECISIONS

This is the project's first milestone and it is still open. Two decisions were taken by default so the work could continue; both remain reversible until IT Section confirms them, and both change what sits underneath a menu item. They must be closed before the navigation bar is designed.

2.1 Close the two open decisions

- **International Student section.** The recommendation is to build it as a filtered view of existing content rather than as a new content type, so that fees, programmes and eligibility are stored once and shown in several places. IT Section needs to confirm or reject this.
- **Games & Sports.** Currently classified as a student body with a coordinator, consistent with the clubs. If it is really just an information page about facilities, it should be reclassified — a one-field change now, a rebuild later.

Send both as a plain yes or no question, with the consequence of reversal stated. Do not let them stay provisional through the navigation work.

2.2 Confirm the top level of the site

Six sections currently exist: About, Academics, Admissions, News & Notices, Research, Student Life. That set is the menu. Agree it before the bar is designed, not while it is being designed.

2.3 Fill in the menu and site settings records

The menu and contact-details records in Strapi are still empty, so the website is running on a hard-coded fallback list. That means the College cannot currently edit its own menu. The script to fill them in is written and waiting; it needs a temporary permission change on the access token to run.

2.4 Build the four missing listing pages

News, Recruitment, Tenders and Downloads are linked from the News & Notices page and currently lead nowhere. They use the same listing pattern as Announcements and Events, which already work.

2.5 Give every old page a destination

The audit of the live site found 215 addresses. Each one needs a decision: move it, merge it, or retire it. Any address without a decision becomes a broken link on launch day and a redirect written under pressure at the worst possible moment.

Done when: no decision in the log is still marked open, and every top-level menu item leads to a page that actually appears.

Phase 3 — Rebuild the navigation bar

3 TO 4 DAYS

The navigation bar is deliberately plain: no drop-down menus, no menus that open on hover. Each top-level item leads straight to its section page. This came from research showing that drop-down menus on university sites hide content rather than reveal it. It is a decision, not an oversight — this phase improves the bar without putting drop-downs back.

The bar is made of five separate pieces. Each has its own job and its own problems.

The five pieces and what is wrong with each

Piece	What it is	What needs fixing
Utility bar	The thin dark strip above everything, holding links to Library, LMS and other College systems, plus Search.	It shows whatever the settings record holds — which is nothing, because that record is empty. Fix in step 2.3, then limit it to five links.
Masthead	The navy band with the crest, the College name and "Kanglung" beneath it, with a gold line under it.	Replace the 1.6 MB photograph of the crest with the SVG from step 1.6. Decide whether it stays put or follows the reader down the page.
Main menu	The six section links across the navy band on wide screens.	It currently disappears below 1024 pixels, so tablet users get only a hamburger button. That is the single biggest usability problem in the bar.
Mobile panel	The list that opens when the menu button is tapped.	Needs to trap keyboard focus while open, close on the Escape key, and return focus to the button. It currently does none of these.
Bottom tabs	Four fixed buttons at the bottom of phone screens: Home, Calendar, Notices, Search.	The icons are emoji. Emoji look different on every phone and cannot take the gold highlight colour. Replace with proper drawn icons.

3.1 Fix the tablet gap

Move the point at which the main menu appears from 1024 pixels down to 760 pixels, with tighter spacing between items. One line of change, the largest single improvement in this phase. If the gap is being kept on purpose, write down why.

3.2 Replace the bottom-tab emoji with real icons

Drawn icons that inherit the current text colour, so the selected tab can turn gold like everything else on the site.

3.3 Make the mobile panel keyboard-safe

Focus stays inside the panel while it is open, Escape closes it, focus returns to the menu button afterwards. Someone using a keyboard or a screen reader must be able to get in and out of the menu.

3.4 Connect the bar to real content

Once step 2.3 is done, the bar reads the menu from the content system and the hard-coded fallback list is deleted. Keeping the fallback would mean an empty menu still looks fine, which hides the fault instead of showing it.

3.5 Check it at four screen widths

375 pixels (phone), 760 (large phone / small tablet), 1024 (tablet), 1280 (laptop). At every width: every link reachable by pressing Tab, the focus outline clearly visible against the navy, and no way to get stuck.

Done when: the navigation is drawn from the content system, works at all four widths, and can be operated entirely by keyboard.

Phase 4 — Finish the page templates

1 TO 2 WEEKS

The ten templates exist, but they have only ever been seen with no content in them. A design that looks correct while empty often falls apart the moment real text and real photographs arrive.

4.1 Design three states for every template

Full, sparse, and empty. A department with no staff listed and no programmes attached must still look deliberate rather than broken. Most of the site will be in the sparse state for its first year.

4.2 Enforce the photograph shapes in the design, not in the instructions

Wide 16:9 for banners, 3:2 for cards and articles, upright 4:5 for portraits. Build the constraint into the page so that a member of staff uploading a square photograph cannot break a grid.

4.3 Make photo consent actually work

A staff portrait must not appear on the website unless written consent has been recorded against that person. A portrait without recorded consent must behave exactly as if there were no portrait at all. This is currently a field in the database that nothing checks.

4.4 Re-check the page weight with real content

The site has a firm limit: 500 KB per page, and no JavaScript by default. It passed that test against 277 words of placeholder content. It has never been tested against real pages with real photographs. Many students will open this site on a phone over a slow connection, which is the entire reason the limit exists.

Done when: every template has been photographed in all three states, and the page-weight limit still passes with real content.

Phase 5 — Load the real content

SEVERAL WEEKS • THE LONGEST PART OF THE PROJECT

This phase is mostly not developer work. It depends on departments, HR/Admin and a photographer, and it is the part most likely to determine when the site can launch.

5.1 Three departments first

Humanities & Social Sciences, Mathematical & Data Sciences, Natural Sciences. Prove the whole process works on three before opening it to every unit in the College. This is the project's second milestone.

5.2 Set up the three roles before contributors arrive

Super Admin, Publisher, Contributor. Roles created after people start working means either everyone has full rights for a while, or everyone waits.

5.3 Fill in governance fields on the existing programmes

The 8 programmes already entered are missing their owning unit and last-reviewed date, because those fields were left optional so as not to block unrelated edits. Once they are filled in, make both fields compulsory — otherwise content can stay unowned indefinitely, which is how the old site became unmaintainable.

5.4 Run the portrait shoot in three department blocks

Written consent captured at the shoot itself, on the day, not chased by email for weeks afterwards. Without consent the photograph cannot be published, so consent is part of the shoot, not paperwork that follows it.

Done when: three departments are completely live — real text, real photographs, real ownership recorded against every page.

Phase 6 — Infrastructure and launch

ONGOING · TWO ITEMS HERE ARE ALREADY OVERDUE

6.1 The live website is compromised — this cannot wait

The audit found gambling spam embedded in the body of the live College homepage, and a spam sitemap containing roughly 2,000 addresses dated January 2024. This belongs to whoever owns the hosting and it is independent of this project's timeline.

It should be dealt with now. It is damaging the College's search reputation every day it stays up, and it will not be fixed by launching a new site on top of it.

6.2 Move the content database onto a real database

The content currently lives in a development-grade file that is being stored inside Git as a stop-gap so it could travel between machines. That was a deliberate temporary measure, recorded as such. It needs to become a proper PostgreSQL database before it becomes a habit.

6.3 Set up real backups

Daily, stored somewhere other than the College server, and restored at least once to prove they work. A backup that has never been restored is not a backup.

6.4 Build the release process, then switch over

An automated build, the redirect list from step 2.5, then the cut-over from old site to new.

Done when: a restore from backup has been performed successfully, and every audited address either resolves or redirects.

4. How each working session runs

Every session starts the same way

- Run `git status` before touching anything. Phase 0 exists because this step was skipped once.
- Name the phase and the step being worked on, so the scope is bounded before the first change is made.
- Build and check before saving anything to Git. A build that runs cleanly is the definition of finished.

Every session ends the same way

- Any decision made along the way is written into `docs/DECISIONS.md` — the situation, the options, the choice, and what it commits us to.
- Commit to the branch and push. One laptop is not a backup.
- Anything postponed is written down as postponed, never quietly dropped.

Rules that are not reopened

- The mobile layout is the starting point, and every screen-size rule adds to it upwards. This is visible in the code and is checked mechanically, not by eye.
- No rounded corners, no drop shadows. This is a deliberate house style, not an omission.
- The content system is never exposed to the public internet. It is read once, when the site is built.
- Every fact is stored in exactly one place. Content is never copied between sections.

5. Decisions needed from IT Section

These block Phase 2, and Phase 2 blocks the navigation work. Each needs only a yes or a no.

#	Question	If the answer is no
1	Should the International Student section be built as a filtered view over existing content, rather than as its own content type?	It becomes a new content type, and fees, eligibility and programme information will exist in two places that must be kept in step.
2	Is Games & Sports a staffed body with a coordinator, like the clubs?	It is reclassified as a single information document — a one-field change if done now.
3	Is the top level of the site confirmed as About, Academics, Admissions, News & Notices, Research and Student Life?	The menu and every section page change, and Phase 3 restarts.
4	Can the crest be supplied as an SVG file?	The masthead ships with a photograph of the crest, which loads slowly and looks soft on high-resolution screens.
5	Who owns fixing the spam on the live production site, and by when?	The College's search reputation continues to degrade daily until someone is named.

6. What is not part of this project

The network upgradation and server room migration

The Request for Proposal covering the core switch, 32 Wi-Fi 7 access points, structured cabling and the server room migration is a separate procurement with a 120-day contract period. It shares a campus with this project and nothing else. It changes what the website is served over; it does not change what the website is.

The Moodle plugin update

The mod_hvp update is a different system on a different maintenance schedule. One practical warning: the installer states that the existing plugin directory `/var/www/moodle/public/mod/hvp` will be removed. Take a backup of that directory and of the Moodle database before pressing Continue.

7. Where to start, today

Step 0.1. Open a command window in the project folder and run `git status`. Send the list of deleted files to whoever is doing the development work. That single output decides whether the next hour is a one-command restore or an investigation — and every other step in this plan is waiting on the answer.

Once the build runs clean, Phase 1 can begin the same day. Phases 1 and 2 can run alongside each other, because the colour decisions and the structure decisions involve different people.